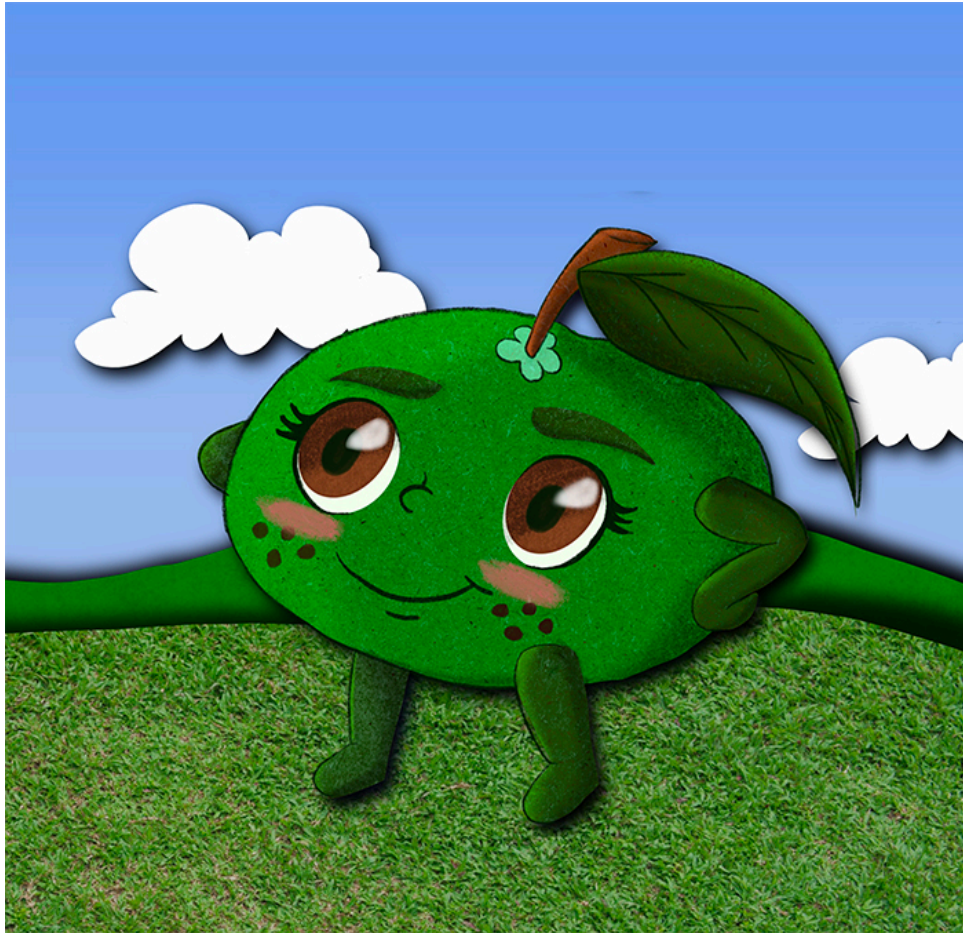




Super Wanda
Myla C. Ogaya
Marly P. Espiritu





Magkakatabi sa kagubatan ngunit
hindi nagpapansinan. Tatlong
bungang-kahoy isa ang kalaban.
Iba, sampalok, kalamansi laban
kay batuan.
Yay! Ang asim! Yay! Ang asim!



Pagsikat ng araw, apat na bunga
ang nagsibabaaan mula sa
kanilang tahanan.

“Tara! Laro tayo!” Pagyayaya ni
Wanda Batuan.

Walang sumagot.

Tahimik ang lahat,

Ang asim ng tatlo! Pati ugali
maasim din.



“Tara! Magkantahan tayo!”
pagyayaya ulit ni Batuan. Walang
sumagot.

Tahimik ang lahat,
Ang asim ng tatlo! Pati ugali
maasim din.

“Tara, sumayaw tayo!” yaya ulit ni
batuan.



Masama ang tingin ni Olin Iba.
Nang-irap si Tamar Sampalok.
Sumimangot si Edan Kalamansi.
“Ewan sa’yo, Wanda!” sabay-
sabay nilang sagot



Bumalik si Wanda sa kaniyang sanga. Umupo, walang kausap. Nanalamin sa patak ng hamog na naiwan sa dahon. Hinawakan ang katawang baluktot at puno ng batik.



Iba ang itsura ni Wanda, kaya
ayaw ng lahat sa kaniya. Walang
namamansin, walang
nakikipaglaro. Kahit di siya kasali
sa kasiyahan, tinatanaw lamang
niya ang mga ito at binabantayan.



“Mag-ingat kayo!” sigaw ni Wanda nang makita ang mga hantik. Walang sumagot. Tahimik ang lahat. Paglingon ng tatlo, natakot sila, at tumakbo papunta sa kanilang tirahan.



Nagsiksikan sa sanga sina Olin, Tamar, at Edan. Nagtago sila sa likod ng malapad na dahon. Pasilip-silip sa butas ng dahon habang pinagmamasdan baka umakyat ang mga hantik at sila'y kagatin.



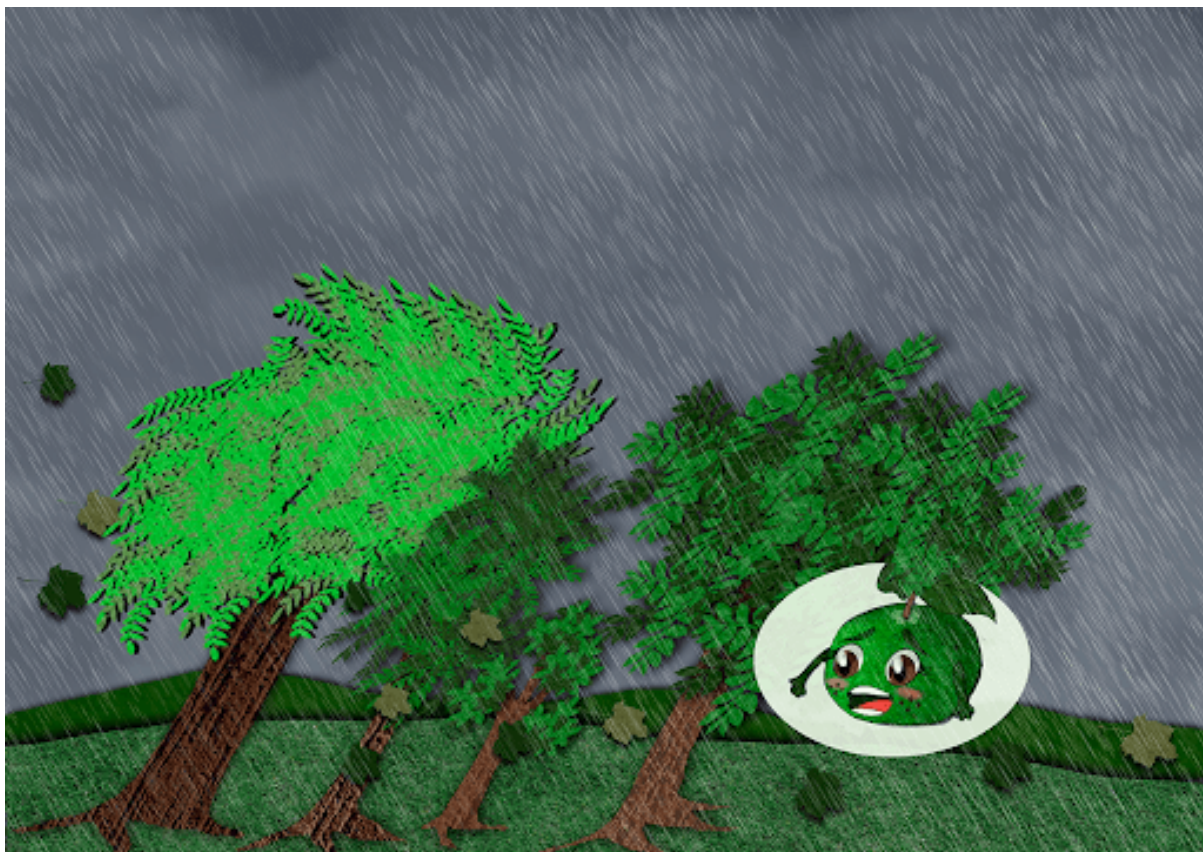
Nakatago din si Wanda sa likod ng mga dahon na ginawa niya bilang panangga. Sinisilip niya rin ang kalagayan ng tatlo. Nanalangin siya, “Sana ligtas sina Olin, Tamar, at Edan.”



“Kumusta kayo diyan, Olin!,
Tamar! Edan!” nag-aalalang
tanong ni Wanda. Walang
sumagot. Tahimik ang lahat.
Yay! Ang asim! Yay! Ang asim!



Naging maasim pati ang panahon.
Maya-maya, dumilim ang
kalangitan, lumakas ang hangin,
bumuhos ang ulan.
Wooosh! Woooosh! Wooooosh!
Napakalakas ng hangin!
Napakalas ng ulan!



Nadala ng hangin ang mga
langgam at mga dahoon. Mahigpit
ang hawak nina Wanda, Olin,
Tamar, at Edan.

“Humawak kayo ng mabuti!” sabi
ni batuan. Walang sumagot.

Tahimik ang lahat.

Sa takot, di makasagot sina Olin,
Tamar, at Edan. Sumasayaw sa
ihip ng hangin at buhos ng ulas

ang mga puno.

Woooooosh! Wooooooosh!

Wooooooooosh!

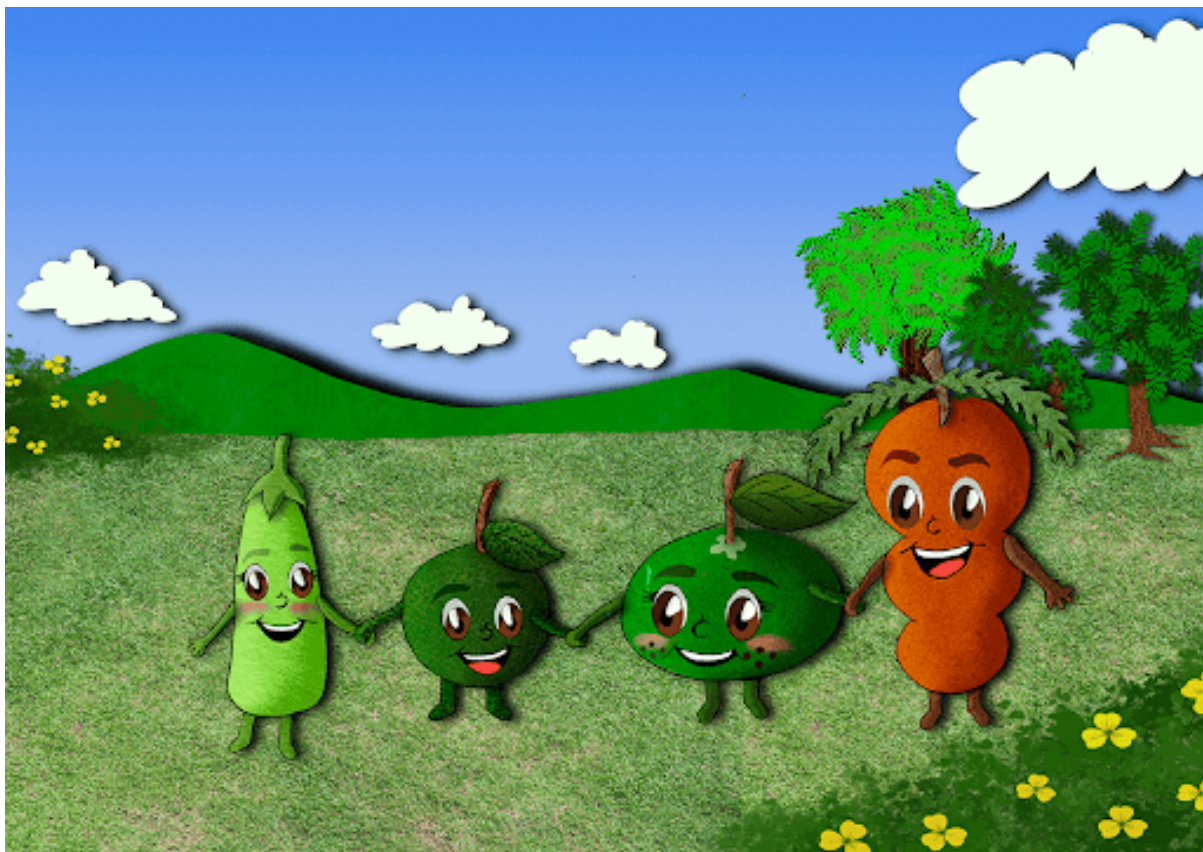
Parang mapuputol, dinuduyan

-

duyan.



Hinawakan ni Wanda ang kamay
ni Edan. Ginaya din ni Tamar at
Olin ang kaniyang ginawa.
Mahigpit na naghawakan silang
apat.
Kaya nakaligtas sila sa malakas
na hangin at ulan.



Magkakatabi sa kagubatan.
Magkakaibigan. Apat na bungang
-
kahoy, magkakampi,
nagtutulungan. Iba, sampalok,
kalamansi, at batuan.
Yay! Ang asim! Yay! Ang asim!
Pero matamis ang pagsasama.



Wonderful Words

Batuan - *Garcinia binucao*

Iba - *Averrhoa bilimbi*

Sampalok - *Tamarindus Indica*

Limon - *Citrofortunella Microcarpa*



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The Asia Foundation

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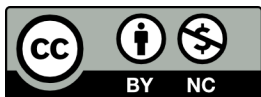
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